aged 18 to 34; another third is 55 and up. But the younger group comprises 42 per cent of the national-religious camp, while their elders represent just 26 per cent. They have a particular foothold in the army, where national-religious soldiers make up a growing share of the officer corps. “The community is gradually taking root in formal and informal positions of power, and entrenching itself at the very heart of public discourse in Israel,” the survey noted.

This is a profound shift in the definition of “Zionism”. It is no longer a secular movement, nor one concerned solely with safety and self-determination for Jews. Indeed, in a combative debate with former US ambassador Martin Indyk at the Saban Forum in Washington in late 2014, Bennett pronounced the era of secular Zionism over. “Modern Zionism was all about creating a shelter for the Jews… it was a secular approach that had the audacity to change history”, Bennett said. “But one hundred years on… the reason we’re in Israel is not because it’s a shelter. It’s our homeland. I want every Israeli child to know our history.”[7]

In Israel, as among the diaspora, there is a debate over the future of Zionism. But it is not one that cares much about the occupation. One side adopts a religious, messianic worldview—the territorial maximalism of the Revisionist movement, without the secularism of its founder, Ze’ev Jabotinsky. The other, it seems, defines Zionism as a belief in transparent accounting.

The garbageman

My late maternal grandmother, Lillian Goldston, was the archetype of a twentieth-century first-generation Ashkenazi immigrant to America. Her parents made the prescient decision to leave Poland in the early 1900s, eager to escape both worsening anti-Semitism and the strictures of *shtetl* life. They arrived in Queens and opened a fruit-and-vegetable shop. Their daughter, my grandmother, went to college, worked in sales, married an accountant; the family, like so many others, became more comfortable and less observant.

In the early 1990s, she made her first trip to Israel. I asked her about it when she came back, and remember her telling me, “It was very strange. I stepped out of my hotel in Jerusalem on the first morning, and there was a garbageman emptying the bins. I noticed that he was wearing a yarmulke. A